

Restart and momentum system

Small wins, steady progress and calm focus. This is your guide to making change stick and restarting with ease when life gets in the way.

THE FOUNDATION

Go deeper than "hacks"

Lasting change rarely fails because of willpower. It fails when a task feels emotionally unsafe. Name the feeling first, then define one small step that feels safe enough to try.



Listen to the resistance. It has something important to tell you.

Name the resistance

Before you try to start small, take 60 seconds to identify the feeling you want to avoid. Naming it reduces its pull.

Your turn: What is the emotion you are avoiding?

Connect to your future self

Link the task to who you want to become and to your future self so the payoff feels real now.

Your turn: This action is a vote for being someone who...

Make the next step safe

After you name the feeling and connect to your future self, define one concrete next step that feels safe.

Create a calm space

Your environment is a powerful signal. Protect a small window of time and remove distractions not as a rule, but as an act of kindness to your future self, making it easier to do what matters.

Remember this: address the feeling first. Action follows.

What to do when you hit a wall

Treat setbacks as data. Use a three step restart: self-compassion, curiosity and adjustment.

Work happens in cycles

Your alertness rises and falls across the day. A drop in motivation often signals a need to rest rather than a failure. Respect short recovery periods to protect learning.

Practice analytical self-compassion

The old rule "never miss twice" is brittle. Instead, use this 3-step process:

- 1. Compassion:** "This is a normal part of the process."
- 2. Curiosity:** "What can I learn from this? What made it hard?"
- 3. Adjustment:** "How can I make the next step 50% easier?"

THE MODEL

The new restart and momentum model

These are the five deep levers of sustainable action. Instead of forcing behavior, you are creating the conditions where motivation naturally appears.

1. Emotional clarity

Identify the feeling that blocks action.

2. Psychological safety

Shrink the step so it stops feeling threatening.

3. Intrinsic satisfaction

Support autonomy and competence in the way you work.

4. Identity alignment

Connect the action to your future self.

5. Energy matching

Fit tasks to your current alertness.

YOUR TURN

Your 5 minute restart checklist

Use this checklist to move from resistance to action in a calm, deliberate way.

- ☐ **Name the feeling.**
- ☐ **Write one if-then plan.**
- ☐ **Define one tiny, safe step.**
- ☐ **Match task to current energy.**
- ☐ **Close with a short ritual so the win is felt.**

Progress: 0/5

Make progress tangible

Your brain benefits from a short closure ritual so progress feels real.

Checking a digital box is weak. To make a new habit stick, create a "Ritual of Closure" that is sensory and immediate. This anchors the feeling of success in your body, not just on your screen.

Auditory: Set a timer. The sound means "victory," not "stop."

Kinesthetic: Stand up, stretch and say "Done" out loud.

Visual: Put a marble in a jar for every focus session completed. Seeing the jar fill up is deeply satisfying.

WORKSHEET

Design your energy menu

Stop trying to do high-energy work with a low-energy brain. Instead, match the task to your current state. This is not procrastination; it is smart allocation. You are always productive, just differently.

Build your menus for the day

List a few tasks for each energy level. When you feel resistance, do not force it. Just pick from a different menu.

✓ **High Energy:**

e.g., draft a proposal, deep analysis, code a feature

✓ **Medium Energy:**

e.g., reply to priority emails, follow ups, plan a project

✓ **Low Energy:**

e.g., organize files, tag notes, outline tomorrow

The daily sprint: rhythm is everything

Use 50 to 90 minute focus blocks without notifications, then 10 to 20 minutes of quiet wakeful rest. The idea of a fixed 90 minute rhythm is debated, so test what works for you.

1. The setup (2 min)

Before you start, clarify your single intention for this sprint. Name the emotion, connect to your identity and clear your space.

2. The focus (50-90 min)

Set a timer and immerse yourself in the task. No distractions. When your mind wanders, gently bring it back to your single point of focus.

3. Quiet wakeful rest (10-20 min)

This is quiet wakeful rest. Walk, stretch and stare out the window. Let your brain consolidate.

4. The closure (1 min)

Perform your sensory ritual. Put the marble in the jar. Say "Done." Physically mark the end of the cycle before deciding on your next move.

Why this approach works

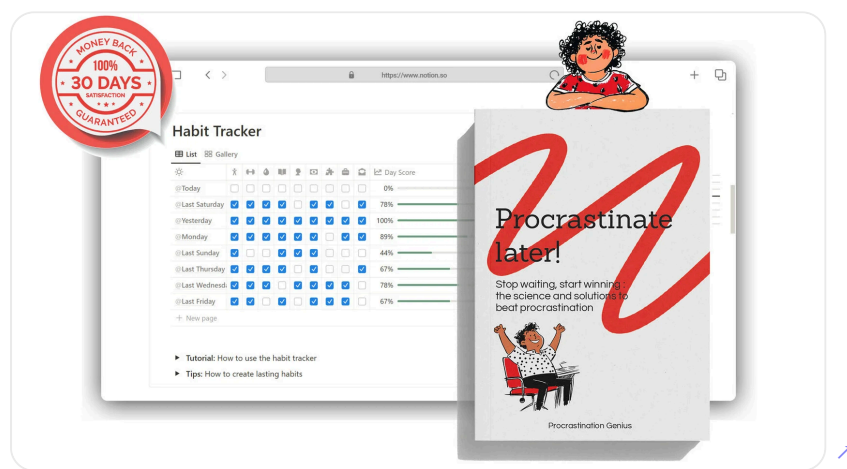
It reduces threat, supports basic psychological needs and turns intentions into action through simple cues. Tiny repeated wins become habits.

NEXT STEPS

Ready for the next step?

The Procrastination Genius complete system [↗](#)

Get the full system, including the playbook and Notion Command Center, to turn these ideas into a daily practice.



SOURCES

Evidence and further reading

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